

University Hostel and Dormitory Handbook

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1. Introduction and Philosophy

1.1 Welcome to the University residential community. The residential life experience is designed to be an integral part of your educational journey, fostering personal growth, independence, and cross-cultural understanding.

1.2 This handbook serves as the definitive guide to the rules, policies, and procedures governing all on-campus residential facilities, including traditional dormitories, suite-style complexes, and university-owned apartments.

1.3 By signing the Housing Contract, every resident legally agrees to abide by the stipulations contained within this document. Ignorance of these rules does not constitute a valid defense in disciplinary proceedings.

1.4 The Directorate of Student Residences (DSR) is committed to providing a safe, clean, and conducive environment for study and rest. We expect all residents to contribute to this atmosphere through mutual respect, cooperation, and responsible behavior.

2. Room Allocation and Occupancy Policy

2.1 Room allocations are processed annually. Returning students participate in a lottery system during the Spring semester, while first-year students are assigned rooms based on their application preferences and availability.

2.2 The University reserves the right to consolidate vacancies. If your roommate moves out, you may be required to move to another partially occupied room or accept a newly assigned roommate at any point during the semester.

2.3 Unauthorized room changes are strictly prohibited. Any resident wishing to change rooms must submit a formal Room Transfer Request to the Residential Life Office. Moves can only take place during the designated "Room Freeze" lifting period, typically in the third week of the semester.

2.4 Subletting of university housing or allowing unauthorized individuals to reside in the room is a severe violation that will lead to immediate eviction and disciplinary action.

2.5 Residents are responsible for the condition of their assigned room. An inventory and condition report must be completed and signed within 48 hours of check-in. At check-out, any damages not recorded on the initial form will be billed to the resident's university account.

3. Guest & Visitor Policy

3.1 The University values the privacy and security of its residents. While socialization is encouraged, the rights of roommates and neighbors to study and sleep unhindered must take precedence.

3.2 A "guest" is defined as any individual who is not officially assigned to live in the specific room or suite in question. This includes residents from other university dormitories as well as off-campus individuals.

3.3 The resident host must accompany their guests at all times while within the residential facility. The host is held completely accountable for the behavior of their guests and for any damages they may cause.

3.4 All visitors must vacate the hostel premises by 9:00 PM. No overnight stays by non-residents are permitted under any circumstances.

3.5 Roommates must mutually agree on guest privileges. Any resident has the right to refuse entry to their roommate's guest if they feel uncomfortable or if the guest's presence interferes with their academic pursuits or privacy.

3.6 During specific high-stress periods, such as midterm and final examination weeks, a strict 24-hour no-guest policy may be implemented across all residential facilities.

4. Mess and Dining Hall Rules

- 4.1 All residents of traditional dormitories are required to participate in a mandatory university meal plan. Exemptions are only granted for severe, documented medical or religious dietary restrictions that the campus dining service cannot accommodate.
- 4.2 Proper attire is required in all dining halls. Pajamas, bare feet, and swimwear are not permitted.
- 4.3 Removing food, dishware, or cutlery from the dining halls is considered theft. Only designated "grab-and-go" items may be taken out of the facility.
- 4.4 The dining halls strive to minimize food waste. Residents are encouraged to take only what they can consume. Repeated, excessive wastage may result in a formal warning from dining management.
- 4.5 Sick trays can be arranged for residents who are ill and unable to visit the dining hall. The resident must submit an online request or have a friend present a sick tray authorization note from the Resident Assistant (RA).

5. Maintenance, Housekeeping, and Hygiene

- 5.1 The University's Facilities Management division is responsible for maintaining the physical infrastructure, common areas, and shared bathrooms.
- 5.2 Residents are solely responsible for the cleanliness and hygiene of their individual rooms and suite interiors.
- 5.3 Any maintenance issues (e.g., plumbing leaks, electrical faults, broken furniture) must be reported promptly via the online Maintenance Work Order system. In case of emergency (e.g., flooding), the front desk or RA on duty should be contacted immediately.
- 5.4 Residents must not attempt to repair university property themselves. Unauthorized alterations, including painting, drilling holes, or installing permanent fixtures, are prohibited and will incur fines.
- 5.5 Regular room inspections will be conducted once per semester to ensure health, safety, and fire code compliance. A notice of at least 48 hours will be provided prior to standard inspections.
- 5.6 Trash and recyclables must be disposed of properly in the designated central collection bins located on each floor or outside the building. Leaving trash in hallways or stairwells is a health hazard and subject to a minimum \$50 fine.

6. Disciplinary Code and Prohibited Items

- 6.1 The residential environment requires strict adherence to the University's behavioral standards to ensure the safety and comfort of all residents.
- 6.2 The possession, use, or distribution of illegal drugs, unauthorized prescription medications, and drug paraphernalia is strictly prohibited and will result in immediate housing contract termination and referral to law enforcement.
- 6.3 The University maintains a dry campus policy. The possession, consumption, or storage of alcoholic beverages, empty alcohol containers, or brewing equipment is forbidden in all residential facilities, regardless of the resident's age.
- 6.4 Prohibited items include, but are not limited to: firearms, explosives, fireworks, knives (with blades longer than 3 inches, excluding kitchen knives in apartment suites), candles, incense, space heaters, halogen lamps, and hoverboards.
- 6.5 Noise levels must be kept at a reasonable volume at all times. "Quiet Hours" are enforced from 10:00 PM to 8:00 AM on weekdays, and 12:00 AM to 10:00 AM on weekends. During quiet hours, noise should not be audible outside the resident's room. "Courtesy Hours" are in effect 24/7, meaning residents must comply if asked to lower their volume by a neighbor or RA.
- 6.6 Pets of any kind, with the exception of non-dangerous fish in tanks no larger than 10 gallons, are prohibited. Approved Service Animals and Emotional Support Animals (ESAs) are permitted only with prior documentation and authorization from the Office of Disability Services.

7. Vacation and Semester Break Policy

7.1 All traditional dormitories close during the Winter and Summer breaks. Residents must vacate their rooms within 24 hours of their last final examination.

7.2 Residents are not required to remove their belongings during the brief Winter break if they are returning to the same room for the Spring semester. However, the University assumes no liability for items left behind.

7.3 During break closures, residents may not access their rooms under any circumstances. Card access will be deactivated.

7.4 A limited number of "Break Housing" accommodations are available for international students, athletes in season, or students with extreme travel hardships. Break housing involves an additional daily fee and may require the resident to temporarily relocate to a consolidated building.

8. Common Room & Recreation Facilities

8.1 Each residential hall is equipped with lounges, study rooms, and recreational areas intended for the exclusive use of the building's residents.

8.2 Furniture and equipment located in common areas must not be removed or relocated to individual student rooms. Doing so will be treated as theft of university property.

8.3 Reservations for study rooms or common spaces for study groups or small events can be made through the RA on duty, subject to availability.

8.4 Residents may host overnight guests in common-area guest rooms with prior written approval from the Warden, provided the guest registers at the hostel office by 6:00 PM and vacates by 11:00 AM the following day.

8.5 The communal kitchens are provided for occasional use. Residents must remain in the kitchen while cooking to prevent fire hazards. All dishes, pots, and surfaces must be thoroughly cleaned immediately after use. Unattended cooking or failure to clean the kitchen will result in the temporary closure of the facility.

8.6 Laundry rooms are open 24 hours. Residents are expected to remove their clothing from washers and dryers promptly to allow others to use the machines. The University is not responsible for damaged or stolen laundry.

9. Safety and Emergency Procedures

9.1 Safety is a shared responsibility. Residents must never prop open exterior doors or allow strangers to "tailgate" behind them into the building.

9.2 Fire alarms must be taken seriously. Every time the alarm sounds, all residents must evacuate the building immediately using the nearest designated stairwell. Do not use elevators during a fire alarm. Failure to evacuate will result in severe disciplinary action and a substantial fine.

9.3 Tampering with fire safety equipment, including smoke detectors, fire extinguishers, pull stations, and sprinkler heads, is a federal offense and will lead to immediate eviction. Covering a smoke detector with plastic or fabric is strictly forbidden.

9.4 In the event of a medical emergency, severe injury, or suspected crime, residents should contact University Police directly. The RA on duty should be notified subsequently to provide on-site support and file an incident report.

9.5 The University utilizes an emergency mass notification system (SMS and email). Residents must ensure their contact information is up to date in the university portal to receive crucial alerts regarding severe weather, active threats, or campus closures.

End of Handbook